



### **PLAYING FOR NOBILITY**

In this scene painted by Henryk Siemiradzki in 1887, Chopin plays in the salon of his patron, Prince Antoni Radziwiłł, at the prince's palace in Berlin.

## **A final return**

Back in Paris, Chopin continued to deteriorate and he died—probably of tuberculosis—on October 17, 1849, aged 39. In his final days he was visited by a host of friends and acquaintances, one of whom (the singer Pauline Viardot) remarked cynically that all the great ladies of Paris came to his rooms to faint.

After a funeral service attended by 3,000 people at the church of the Madeleine, its facade draped in black velvet, Chopin was buried in Père Lachaise Cemetery. However, at his request, his heart was removed and taken back to Poland, where it rests beneath a monument to him in the church of the Holy Cross, Warsaw.